Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣A

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦A

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 9 8 3 ♥ 2 ♦ A K ♣ K Q J 8	
♠ 10 5 ♥ 8 6 3 ♦ 10 9 6 5 4 ♣ A 9 6		♠ 6 ♥ A J 10 9 7 ♦ Q J 7 3 ♣ 10 4 2
	♠ J 7 4 2 ♥ K Q 5 4 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 7 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by North
Lead: ♦Q

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q 10 2 ♥ 5 3 2 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 9 8 5 3 2	
♠ A 6 4 ♥ K J 9 ♦ A K Q J 9 ♣ K Q		♠ J 3 ♥ A Q 10 8 6 ♦ 10 3 ♣ J 10 7 4
	♠ K 9 8 7 5 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 7 6 5 4 ♣ A 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

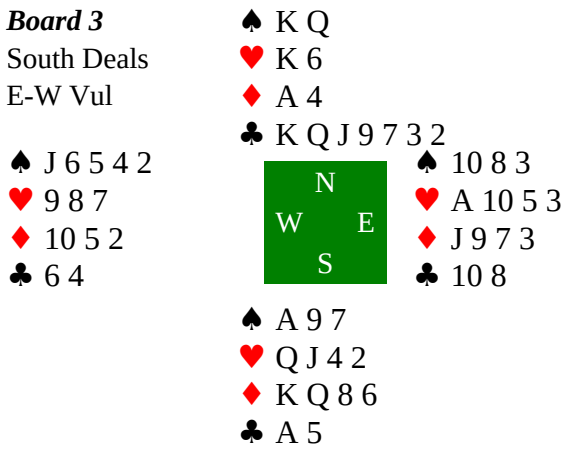
1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣A

EAST makes a positive 3♥ response to WEST's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

WEST only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the EAST hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠4

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made. SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 ♥ Q 10 ♦ J 9 6 5 4 2 ♣ Q J 3 2	
♠ A K Q 6 4 3 ♥ K 5 ♦ K 7 3 ♣ A K		♠ J 9 5 2 ♥ A J 7 4 3 ♦ A Q ♣ 9 8
	♠ 10 7 ♥ 9 8 6 2 ♦ 10 8 ♣ 10 7 6 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

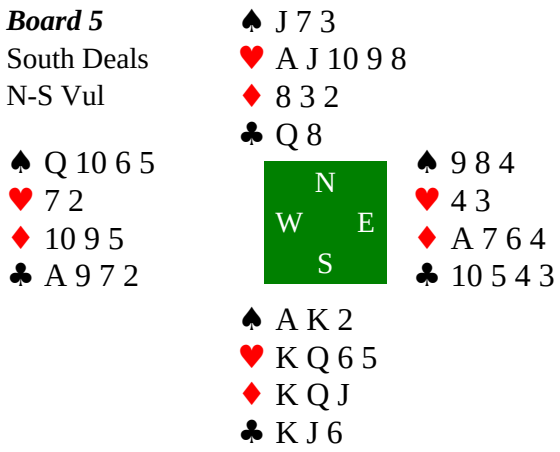
7NT by West
Lead: ♣Q

WEST has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When EAST supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that EAST has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that EAST will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by North
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.